# The Road to Strimzi 1.0

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# Strimzi 1.0 is (almost) here!



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# Strimzi 1.0 roadmap

- 1.0.0 and **`v1`** CRD API **Proposal** (September 2025)
- Strimzi **0.49** + **`v1`** CRD API (November 2025)
- Strimzi **0.50** (January 2026) + Strimzi **0.51** (early March 2026)
- Strimzi **1.0** (April 2026)



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# Main changes

- The **v1** CRD API
  - Introduced in Strimzi 0.49.0
  - Big API cleanup
    - Deprecated fields from the v1beta2 API were removed (ZooKeeper, ...)
    - Removed many specific APIs in favour of extensible APIs (OPA, OAuth, ...)



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# Upgrade

- Flexible upgrade path
  - Start with Strimzi <= 0.48
  - Middle step Strimzi 0.49 - 0.51
  - Finish it by moving to 1.x
- `v1` API Conversion tool to help with the CR and CRD upgrade



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- Supports only the old **`v1beta2`** API
- KRaft-based Apache Kafka clusters only

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- Upgrade to Strimzi 0.49 - 0.51
- Supports both **`v1beta2`** and **`v1`** APIs
- Allows you to get familiar with the **`v1`** API
- Migrate of the deprecated APIs
- Start using the **`v1`** API

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- Update you custom resources to **`v1`** latest before upgrading to 1.0 or older
- Upgrade the CRDs to allow removing **`v1beta2`** API **right before** upgrade to 1.0 or older
- Use the **`v1`** API conversion tool

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- Upgrade to 1.0 or later **right after** the CRD Upgrade
- **`v1beta2`** is removed when the CRDs are installed and cannot be used anymore

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# Conversion Tool

- Helps to deal with the new CRD version
- Convert custom resources in-place or in files
  - **`convert-file`** and **`convert-resource`** options
- “Upgrade” the CRDs
  - Required to remove the old **`v1beta2`** version; **`crd-upgrade`** option



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# What took as so long?



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# … almost 7000 PRs …



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# … 51 minor releases …



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# 8 years ...



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Strimzi - Apache Kafka on Ku

strimzi.io

The Kube-native management of Kafka is not limited to the broker. You can also manage Kafka topics, users, Kafka MirrorMaker and Kafka Connect using Custom Resources. This means you can use your familiar Kubernetes processes and tooling to manage complete Kafka applications.

Do you want to contribute to the Strimzi project? Learn how you can contribute on our Join Us page.

**PROJECT ROADMAP**

Learn about the future plans for the project by viewing the roadmap.

## Strimzi users

helvetia · Lightbend · GRUPOMASMOVIL · SBB CFF FFS · swisscom · randoli · alauda.io · skillsoft

ATRUVIA · baloise · AppsFlyer · LITTLE HORSE · DECATHLON DIGITAL · SMART · HETZNER · COZYSTACK

reddit · Procure AI · MARLOW NAVIGATION · feedzai · pattern · CERN

## Strimzi vendors

Red Hat · axual · CLOUDERA · AE · IBM

CLOUD NATIVE COMPUTING FOUNDATION

We are a Cloud Native Computing Foundation incubating project.

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Strimzi provides a way to run an Apache Kafka cluster on Kubernetes in various deployment configurations.

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# What took us so long?

- We knew that ZooKeeper removal will bring many breaking changes
  - It seemed reasonable to wait with 1.0 after it is done
  - Took way longer than initially expected
- **Sunk cost fallacy**



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# Making the most of it

- KRaft support
- `StrimziPodSets` and `KafkaNodePools`
- Horizontal autoscaling
- and more



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# What’s next?



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# KRaft Dynamic Quorum

- Changing controllers topology dynamically
- Scales controllers without downtime
- High Availability of the KRaft quorum



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# KRaft Dynamic Quorum

- KRaft quorum reconciliation
- Scaling controllers … but also:
  - Removing or Adding controller role to/from broker nodes
  - Handling of JBOD disk failures/changes
- Automatic migration from static to dynamic quorum



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# Cert-manager integration

- Delegate certificates lifecycle management
- Decouples certificate management from Kafka operations
- Supports both cluster and clients CA

# Auto-rebalancing

- Leveraging Cruise Control anomaly detection
- Operator runs the rebalance via `KafkaRebalance` resource to fix goal violations
  - Cruise Control self-healing is not involved
- Complete the rebalancing features in Strimzi
  - On scaling up/down, move data across disks, fix anomalies



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# Gateway API

- Yesterday … Ingress NGINX retired
- Bring your own Gateway (Envoy, Istio, Cilium, …)
- `TLSRoute` is finally available in the standard channel (since 1.5.0)
  - Support for both TLS Passthrough and TLS Termination
  - Created by the Strimzi operator based on a “listener” configuration



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# STRIMZICON

June 3, 2026

https://strimzi.io/conference

# CfP is open!

- Submit at https://sessionize.com/StrimziConVirtual2026/ by **March 31st**
  - Core Strimzi
  - Case Studies
  - Integrations
  - Operations



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# Visit us in Project Pavilion!

# Kiosk P-1B



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